

Matthew Beardwell

Watford, Hertfordshire · mbeardwell.com · contact@mbeardwell.com
[LinkedIn](#) · [GitHub](#) · [TryHackMe](#)

Professional Summary

SOC Analyst Trainee with hands-on cybersecurity experience and a First-Class BSc (Hons) in Computer Science. Skilled in HUMINT-style OSINT investigative techniques, now applying this toward infosec workflows. Ranked in the top 2% globally on TryHackMe (114 completed rooms, 16 badges). Currently preparing for CompTIA Security+ to strengthen expertise in SIEM, SOC operations, and incident response.

Technical Skills

- Security and Threat Detection:** SIEM (Splunk), Sysmon, Windows Logs, OSINT
- Scripting and Programming:** Python, Bash, PowerShell, C, ARM ASM
- Systems Admin:** Group Policy, Linux Hardening, Virtualisation
- Incident Response:** Wireshark, TCP/IP, Firewalls

Cybersecurity Projects

‘ActiveReconLite’: A Python Port Scanner Feb 2025 – Mar 2025
Built a Python-based TCP connect port scanner using multiprocessing. Scanned 65k ports in 5s (vs Nmap’s 5m). It validates user input, grabs banners, and writes results to a file. Demonstrates automation, socket programming, and parallel scanning.
Technologies: Python, Multiprocessing, Network Scanning
github.com/mbeardwell/active-recon-lite

‘Faster Dynamically Instrumented Programs’ · Bachelor’s Thesis Oct 2022 – May 2023
Designed and implemented a dynamic code modification technique that intercepts processor instructions at run-time, demonstrating low-level reverse engineering and malware analysis applications.
Technologies: C, ARM Assembly, Dynamic Binary Instrumentation
github.com/mbeardwell/arm-fp-emu

Professional Experience

Building expertise during ongoing health recovery. Not currently available for roles. Open to future opportunities.

SOC Training and Labs · TryHackMe (Self-Led Learning) Feb 2022 – Present
Developed hands-on expertise in SIEM, threat hunting, and security automation through 114 cybersecurity labs (Top 2% globally). Applied log analysis, detection logic, and SOC tooling in simulation labs.

Retail Assistant · Max Spielmann (Prince’s Trust Work Placement) Feb 2024 – Mar 2024
Processed transactions, assisted customers with self-service kiosks and mobile integration, and ensured secure deletion of processed passport photos.

Private Tutor · Freelance Sep 2016 – Nov 2019
Supported children with pre-GCSE homework, primarily in maths; adapted explanations to varying ability levels in informal settings.

Research and Documentation Intern · Indo UK Institute of Health Jun 2017 – Aug 2017
Conducted market research on employee benefits and strategic partnerships, providing executives with key insights. Edited and reformatted high-level strategic documents that shaped discussions on a billion-pound health-care initiative.

Education and Certifications

BSc (Hons) CS · King’s College London		1st Class	2018–2023
A-Levels · King’s Maths School		4 A*s	2016–2018
GCSEs · John Lyon School		9 A*s, 1 B	2014–2016
Certifications			
CompTIA	Security+		(In Progress)
TryHackMe	Intro to Cyber Security		Feb 2024
TryHackMe	Pre-Security		Apr 2022
Security Blue Team	Intro to OSINT		Jun 2025
Prince’s Trust	TEAM (12-week programme incl. First Aid)		Jan 2024 – Apr 2024